as he did and to promote changes he knew would help the world. They voice his helplessness when things did not turn out as he had hoped they would, alongside his irritation and frustration, as well as his dream for the future.

Nehru is the only Indian prime minister to date who discussed foreign policy issues in speeches across the country. He explained, sometimes to an audience of illiterate peasants, why India had signed a treaty or refused to sign one or why non-alignment was the best course for India. India's literacy rate at the time was abysmally low, standing at around 12 per cent in 1947.[18] When asked why he discussed foreign policy in remote villages, Nehru responded by arguing that the masses would understand complex decisions only if they were explained to them.

Nehru sought to lead by personal example, sometimes even at the cost of concentrating too much work in his office. As prime minister he often replied personally to diplomatic cables from various Indian missions rather than wait for his officials to do so. During his seventeen years in power, Nehru made it a point to attend every session of parliament held while he was in Delhi, to emphasize the importance of parliamentary responsibility. He answered almost every question directed at the government, whether related to foreign policy or economics. As one of Nehru's foreign secretaries noted, 'The heaviest burden during the Parliament session was his practice of briefing himself in the minutest detail on every question that was to be answered, not only the questions relating to the Ministry of External Affairs but on all the questions of all the ministries in the government.'[19] This centralization was not always appreciated by cabinet ministers or civil servants, who saw it as a recipe for slowing down the wheels of government.

Nonetheless, Nehru's policies helped India achieve a certain stature on the global stage. Nehru's successors retained the policies and institutions he crafted, making only cosmetic changes to the Nehruvian framework. Nehru